

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

VOL. CLXXV No. 60,875

© 2026 The New York Times Company

TUESDAY, MAY 5, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



James Kamau Ndungu’s widow and daughter at his memorial service in March in Kenya. He hadn’t been heard from since August.

Court Restores Access by Mail To Abortion Pill

By ANN E. MARIMOW and PAM BELLUCK

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court on Monday restored nationwide access to a widely used abortion medication in a temporary order that will, for now, allow women to once again obtain the pill mifepristone by mail.

In a brief order, Justice Samuel A. Alito Jr. paused a lower-court ruling from Friday that had prevented abortion providers from prescribing the pills by telemedicine and shipping them to patients, causing confusion for providers and patients. The one-sentence order imposes a pause until at least May 11. He requested that the parties file briefs by Thursday, and then the full court will determine how to proceed.

The state of Louisiana sued the Food and Drug Administration to restrict access to mifepristone, saying the availability of the medication by mail has allowed abortions to continue in the state despite its near-total ban.

Medication is now the method used in nearly two-thirds of abortions in the United States, and is typically delivered in the form of a two-drug regimen through the first 12 weeks of pregnancy.

Friday’s ruling from the conservative U.S. Court of Appeals for the Fifth Circuit temporarily re-instated an F.D.A. requirement that patients visit medical providers in person to obtain mifepristone while the litigation continues. That rule was first lifted in 2021.

Two manufacturers of mifepristone, Danco Laboratories and GenBioPro, on Saturday asked the Supreme Court to intervene. In court filings, Danco’s lawyers said the Fifth Circuit ruling “in-

Continued on Page A15

Africans Tricked Into Fighting a War for Russia

This article is by Matthew Mpoke Bigg, John Eligon and Zimasa Matiwane.

NAIROBI, Kenya — James Kamau Ndungu told only a few friends that he was heading to Russia. He told them he had been promised a job as a day laborer there. He was 32, unemployed in Kenya and needed the work.

Last June, Mr. Kamau sent a photo to his friends from Istanbul Airport, saying he was in transit, one of the friends said. A few weeks later, he sent another photo. This time, he was wearing fatigues and holding a gun. In August, he wrote to say that he was in a trench in Ukraine. Things were bad. He asked for prayers.

It was the last anyone in Kenya

Offered Civilian Work, Only to End Up at Front in Ukraine

heard from him.

A growing number of Africans are ending up on the front lines of Russia’s war with Ukraine. Some go there willingly as mercenaries, but many more are like Mr. Kamau, young men lured by the promise of ordinary civilian jobs — from bodyguards to line cooks — only to be forced into joining Russian forces in battle.

A string of fly-by-night companies have been set up across the continent to recruit the men. The companies often appear as travel

agencies or job placement firms and advertise on WhatsApp or Telegram.

The New York Times interviewed several victims and recruiters. The interviews suggest that the recruiters do not work directly with the Defense Ministry in Moscow. Contracts seen by The Times were in Russian, meaning the Africans most likely could not read them.

Formal jobs in Africa are scarce, making the promise of work overseas a powerful magnet. And Africa has the fastest-growing youth population on the planet. Many young people are unemployed, making the continent a prime target for the unwitting recruitment of soldiers.

“Why has Russia taken my

Continued on Page A6



Glamorous From the Ground Up

The influencer Emma Chamberlain and the singer Sam Smith at Monday’s Met Gala, which raises money for the museum’s Costume Institute. Coverage at nytimes.com and in Thursday Styles.



NINA WESTERVELT FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

White House Considers Vetting A.I. Models Before Their Release

This article is by Tripp Mickle, Julian E. Barnes, Sheera Frenkel and Dustin Volz.

SAN FRANCISCO — President Trump, who promoted a hands-off approach to artificial intelligence and gave Silicon Valley free rein to roll out the technology, is considering the introduction of government oversight over new A.I. models, according to U.S. officials

and people briefed on the deliberations.

The administration is discussing an executive order to create an A.I. working group that would bring together tech executives and government officials to examine potential oversight procedures, according to U.S. officials, who declined to be identified in order to discuss deliberations over sensitive policies. Among the

Executive Order to End Hands-Off Approach

potential plans is a formal government review process for new A.I. models.

In meetings last week, White House officials told executives from Anthropic, Google and Open-

AI about some of those plans, people briefed on the conversations said.

The working group is likely to consider a number of oversight approaches, officials said. But a review process could be similar to one being developed in Britain, which has assigned several government bodies to ensure that A.I. models meet certain safety stand-

Continued on Page A14



SCIENCE TIMES D1-8

Clear Waters, Murky Morals

Only two places allow tourists to swim with killer whales, but there are growing concerns about the practice. PAGE D1

Risks of ‘Free Birth’ Approach

Critics cite the dangers of the movement, which rejects medical intervention during pregnancy or delivery. PAGE D1

NATIONAL A12-19

An Issue Bridging Parties

Americans have soured on data centers, polls show, and the sentiment is profoundly bipartisan. How will that change our politics? PAGE A13

Opening Parks to Hunters

National parks are expanding where firearms are allowed and permitting cleaning of game in restrooms. PAGE A16

OBITUARIES A20-21

Thuuuuh Voice of the Yankees

John Sterling, 87, who called over 5,600 games for the team, was known for his flair after homers and wins. PAGE A21

BUSINESS B1-6

3 Pulitzerz for The Times

The Washington Post got the award for public service, the most prestigious Pulitzer, for its coverage of the Trump administration’s overhaul of federal agencies. PAGE B1

SpaceX’s Early Stock Owners

Before Elon Musk’s rocket company even holds a major initial public offering, many have been buying shares through a private avenue: so-called special purpose vehicles. PAGE B1

INTERNATIONAL A4-10

Seeking Justice in Hong Kong

Lee Chun Ho lost four members of his household in last year’s apartment-tower blaze. He’s now telling a committee what contractors ignored. PAGE A4

SPORTS B7-10

A Future Without Reese

The Chicago Sky ended a rocky tenure with a star, but are hoping to make progress toward again being in W.N.B.A. playoff contention. PAGE B7

OPINION A22-23

Jessica Nutik Zitter

PAGE A22

THE WEATHER

Today, windy, warm, morning sun, afternoon clouds, high 83. Tonight, cloudy, warm, low 64. Tomorrow, not as warm, cloudy, a few showers, high 67. Weather map, Page A24.

WAVE OF STRIKES IN GULF STRAINS A FRAGILE TRUCE

U.A.E. REPORTS ATTACK

Building Hit in Oman — U.S. Says It Has Sunk Iranian Gunboats

This article is by Aaron Boxerman, Ismaeel Naar and Sanam Mahoozi.

Violence flared anew in and around the Persian Gulf on Monday, as the United Arab Emirates said Iran had fired missiles and drones at its territory and the U.S. military said it sank several Iranian military boats, straining the fragile cease-fire in the Middle East.

The Emirati authorities blamed Iran for attacks on a major oil port and an oil tanker in the Strait of Hormuz, in the first such attacks since the truce began four weeks ago. Oman also reported an attack that injured two people in the coastal town of Bukha, near Emirati territory, without identifying the perpetrator.

Loud booms shook the Emirati city of Dubai as air defense missiles detonated high overhead. U.S. Central Command said it had shot down Iranian missiles and drones aimed at ships and around the strait.

It was not clear if the attacks signaled the collapse of the strained truce and a resumption of active warfare. Iran did not officially confirm or deny that it had resumed attacks, and a senior military official denied on state media that its boats had been sunk.

Iran has frequently targeted energy infrastructure in Gulf countries that host American military bases since Israel and the United States attacked in late February, beginning the war. But those attacks on Iran’s Gulf neighbors more or less came to a halt when a cease-fire went into effect on April 8.

At least three Indian citizens were injured when an Iranian

Continued on Page A9



Iran has effectively blocked the Strait of Hormuz for weeks.

Many U.S. Jews Say Vigilance Is Now a Constant Companion

This article is by Patricia Mazzei, Robert Chiarito, Miles G. Cohen and Mark Bonamo.

Lindsey Liss made a sobering request of her 17-year-old daughter when she sent her on a trip to Europe last summer: Don’t wear a Star of David necklace charm.

“There’s no reason to make yourself a target,” said Ms. Liss, a 51-year-old artist and mother of four who lives in Chicago and grew up outside Detroit, near where an armed man rammed his truck into a synagogue in March.

Diane Rosenthal, 64, who lost two brothers in the 1918 shooting rampage at the Tree of Life synagogue in Pittsburgh, said she thinks twice about going to crowded events.

“I look for the exit doors,” she

said. “Which is not a normal sense of what people should be doing for a joyful occasion, like a graduation.”

Rabbi Shimon Dudai of the Congregation B’nai Zion in Key West, Fla., said that since the Hamas-led attack on Israel on Oct. 7, 2023, he delivers services with a 9-millimeter pistol within arm’s reach.

“I don’t want to come to a holy space like this, a sanctuary, holding a gun,” said Rabbi Dudai, 84, who keeps the pistol in a traditional Jewish lectern used to prop up religious texts. “I just don’t want to take the risk of my people getting hurt if I’m capable of using a gun properly and capable of defending them to the best of my ability.”

From tempering overt displays of their faith, to being hyper alert, to issuing warnings to fellow con-

Continued on Page A19



ARTS C1-6

The Patriotic Schlock of ’76

A quirky collection at Yale features items, from burger wrappers to condoms to clothes hangers, that celebrated America’s bicentennial. PAGE C1

